

Word family: **wake / wakes / woke / woken / waking / awake / awakening**

Base word: wake

Part of speech: mainly **verb**, also **noun** in several distinct senses

Related forms:

- * **wake** (v.) — 醒來；叫醒；喚起
- * **woke** — wake 的過去式
- * **woken** — wake 的過去分詞
- * **waking** — 醒着的；醒來的過程
- * **awake** (adj./v.) — 醒着的；醒來；喚醒
- * **awakening** (n.) — 覺醒；醒悟；意識到
- * **wake up** — 醒來；叫醒；使警覺
- * **wake someone up** — 叫醒某人
- * **wake up to something** — 開始意識到某事
- * **in the wake of** — 在……之後；隨……而來
- * **leave something in your wake** — 在身後留下……
- * **wake** (n.) — 船行經後的尾流
- * **wake** (n.) — 守靈

Useful expressions / extensions:

- * **wake up**
- * **wake someone up**
- * **wake early**
- * **wake from sleep**
- * **wake with a start**
- * **wide awake**
- * **stay awake**
- * **wake up to reality**
- * **a wake-up call**
- * **in the wake of**
- * **ship's wake**
- * **attend a wake**
- * **awakening**
- * **political / cultural awakening**
- * **waking hours**

Meaning in this passage

> I also began **waking up earlier** and doing the hardest tasks first...

Here, **waking up** means:

stopping being asleep and becoming conscious — 醒來；起床

The speaker changed their daily routine by getting up earlier so they could do difficult work while mentally fresh.

中文翻譯：

我也開始**早一點起床**，並先處理最困難的事情。

So here:

wake up = 從睡眠狀態變成清醒狀態

1. **wake up — 醒來；起床**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I began **waking up earlier**.

我開始**早一點起床**。

Practice 2

> I usually **wake up** at seven.

我通常七時**醒來**。

Practice 3

> She **woke up** before the alarm went off.

鬧鐘響之前，她已經**醒來了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake up = 從睡眠狀態變成清醒

2. **wake early / wake up early — 早醒；早起**

Practice 1

> I try to **wake up early** on weekdays.

平日我盡量**早起**。

Practice 2

> He **woke early** because he was nervous.

他因為緊張而**很早醒來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake up early = 在一天較早的時間停止睡覺並起身

3. **wake from sleep — 從睡眠中醒來**

Practice 1

> She **woke from a deep sleep**.

她從熟睡中**醒來**。

Practice 2

> I suddenly **woke from sleep**.

我突然**從睡眠中醒來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake from sleep = 從睡眠狀態恢復意識

4. **wake someone up — 叫醒某人**

A very important transitive pattern.

Practice 1

> Please **wake me up** at six.

請六時**叫醒我**。

Practice 2

> The noise **woke the baby up**.

噪音把嬰兒**吵醒了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake someone up = 使正在睡覺的人醒來

5. **wake someone — 叫醒某人**

Without **up**, still possible.

Practice 1

> Don't **wake the children**.

不要**吵醒孩子**。

Practice 2

> The thunder **woke me** in the middle of the night.

雷聲半夜把我**弄醒了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake someone = 令某人從睡眠中醒來

6. **wake with a start — 猛然驚醒**

Practice 1

> I **woke with a start** after hearing a loud bang.

聽到一聲巨響後，我**猛然驚醒**。

Practice 2

> She **woke with a start** from a bad dream.

她從噩夢中**一下子驚醒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****wake with a start = 因突然受驚而猛然醒來****

7. ****awake (醒着的) — 醒着的 ; 清醒的****

A major related form.

Practice 1

> Are you still ****awake****?

你還****醒着嗎****?

Practice 2

> I was ****wide awake**** at midnight.

我午夜時仍然****非常清醒****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****awake = not asleep****

8. ****wide awake — 完全清醒****

Practice 1

> I was ****wide awake**** after drinking coffee.

喝咖啡後，我****完全清醒****。

Practice 2

> The noise left me ****wide awake****.

噪音令我****完全睡不着 / 非常清醒****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wide awake = 完全清醒，毫無睡意****

9. ****stay awake — 保持清醒 ; 不睡着****

Practice 1

> I struggled to **stay awake** during the lecture.

我上課時很努力才**保持清醒**。

Practice 2

> Coffee helped me **stay awake**.

咖啡幫助我**保持清醒**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stay awake = 繼續保持清醒，不睡着****

10. ****waking hours — 清醒時段****

Practice 1

> I spend most of my ****waking hours**** at work.

我大部分****清醒時間****都在工作。

Practice 2

> During his ****waking hours****, he was constantly checking messages.

在他的****清醒時段****，他不停查看訊息。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****waking hours = 一天中沒有睡覺、保持清醒的時間****

11. ****wake up to something — 開始意識到某事****

A major figurative extension.

Practice 1

> He finally ****woke up to the seriousness of the problem****.

他終於****意識到問題的嚴重性****。

Practice 2

> People are beginning to **wake up to the risks**.

人們開始**察覺到這些風險**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wake up to X = 終於開始意識到或明白 X 的真實情況或重要性****

12. **wake someone up to something — 使某人警覺 / 意識到**

Practice 1

> The experience **woke me up to how badly I was managing my time**.

那次經歷令我**意識到自己的時間管理有多差**。

Practice 2

> The mistake **woke the team up to the need for better planning**.

那次錯誤令團隊**意識到需要更好的規劃**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wake someone up to X = 令某人開始真正意識到 X****

13. **wake-up call — 當頭棒喝；警號**

Extremely relevant to your passage, because the passage itself says:

> That experience was a **wake-up call**.

This is related to **wake** even though it appeared as a compound.

Practice 1

> Missing the deadline was a **wake-up call**.

錯過截止日期是一記**當頭棒喝**。

Practice 2

> The poor result gave him a **wake-up call**.

差劣的結果給了他一個**警號**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake-up call = 一件令人突然意識到問題嚴重性、必須改變的事情

14. **wake-up call (酒店 / 電話：叫醒服務) — 叫醒電話**

The literal service meaning.

Practice 1

> I asked the hotel for a **wake-up call** at six.

我請酒店六時提供**叫醒電話服務**。

Practice 2

> Your **wake-up call** is scheduled for 6:30.

你的**叫醒電話**已安排在六時半。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake-up call = 酒店等在指定時間致電把住客叫醒的服務

15. **awakening (醒悟；覺醒) — 覺醒；開始意識到**

Practice 1

> The experience led to an **awakening** about how I used my time.

那次經歷令我對自己如何使用時間產生了**醒悟**。

Practice 2

> There was a growing **awakening** to the problem.

人們對這個問題逐漸產生**更深的認識**。

MCQ-ready definition:

awakening = 開始深刻意識到某個真相、問題或新想法的過程

16. **cultural / social awakening — 文化 / 社會覺醒**

Practice 1

> The period saw a cultural **awakening**.

那個時期出現了文化**覺醒**。

Practice 2

> The movement contributed to a wider social **awakening**.

這場運動促成了更廣泛的社會**覺醒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

awakening = 某個群體開始更強烈地意識到身份、問題、價值或變化

17. **wake (喚起感情 / 記憶) — 喚起**

A less common but established literary/formal verb extension.

Practice 1

> The song **woke memories** of childhood.

那首歌**喚起了童年回憶**。

Practice 2

> His words **woke a sense of hope** in her.

他的說話在她心中**喚起了希望**。

MCQ-ready definition:

wake a feeling/memory = 使原本沉寂的感情、想法或記憶重新出現

In everyday English, **awaken** or **evoke** is often more natural here.

18. **awaken (喚起 ; 使意識到) — 喚醒 ; 喚起**

Practice 1

> The trip **awakened my interest in history**.

這次旅程**喚起了我對歷史的興趣**。

Practice 2

> The experience **awakened him to the importance of planning**.

那次經歷令他**意識到規劃的重要性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****awaken = 使某種興趣、感情或認知開始出現****

19. **wake (noun : 船尾水流) — 尾流 ; 航跡**

A genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> The boat left a long **wake** behind it.

船在身後留下長長的**尾流**。

Practice 2

> Small boats rocked in the ferry's **wake**.

小船在渡輪留下的**尾流**中搖晃。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wake = 船隻行駛後在水面留下的波浪和水流****

20. **in the wake of — 在……之後 ; 隨……而來**

This idiom comes from the ship's wake metaphor.

Practice 1

> New rules were introduced **in the wake of the accident**.

事故發生後，當局推出了新規則。

Practice 2

> Several changes followed ****in the wake of the crisis****.

危機之後，接連出現了數項改變。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the wake of X = 在重大事件 X 發生之後，通常作為其結果或後續影響****

21. ****leave something in your wake — 在身後留下.....****

Practice 1

> The storm left destruction ****in its wake****.

暴風過後留下了一片****破壞****。

Practice 2

> The sudden change left confusion ****in its wake****.

突如其來的改變在身後留下了****混亂****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave X in your wake = 經過或發生之後留下 X 作為後果****

22. ****wake (noun : 守靈) — 守靈；追悼聚會****

A completely separate noun sense.

Practice 1

> The family held a ****wake**** before the funeral.

家人在葬禮前舉行了****守靈 / 追悼聚會****。

Practice 2

> Friends gathered at the ****wake****.

朋友們聚集在**守靈儀式**上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wake = 葬禮前後親友聚集悼念死者的儀式或聚會****

Important distinction 1: ****wake vs wake up****

**wake**

can be transitive or intransitive.

> I woke at seven.

> 我七時醒來。

> The noise woke me.

> 噪音把我吵醒。

**wake up**

more common in everyday speech for becoming awake.

> I woke up at seven.

For learners, ****wake up**** is generally the safest everyday form.

Important distinction 2: ****wake up vs get up****

Very important.

**wake up**

stop sleeping.

**get up**

leave the bed.

> I woke up at 6:30 but got up at 7:00.

我六時半醒來，但七時才起床。

Your passage says ****waking up earlier****, though the intended routine likely also implies getting out of bed earlier.

Important distinction 3: ****awake vs wake****

****awake****

usually adjective:

> I'm awake.

我醒着。

****wake****

verb:

> I woke up.

我醒來了。

Avoid:

> *I am wake.* ❌

Important distinction 4: ****woke vs woken****

Irregular forms:

> wake → ****woke**** → ****woken****

Past:

> I ****woke**** early yesterday.

Perfect/passive:

> I have ****woken**** early all week.

Not:

> *I have woke* ❌

Important distinction 5: **wake up to something vs notice something**

notice

become aware of something.

wake up to

often implies you had previously failed to appreciate its importance or reality.

> I noticed the problem.

我注意到問題。

> I woke up to the problem.

我終於**醒覺到問題的嚴重性 / 現實**。

Much stronger figurative nuance.

Important distinction 6: **wake-up call vs warning**

warning

direct indication of danger/problem.

wake-up call

an event that shocks you into realizing change is necessary.

A bad result can be a wake-up call even if nobody explicitly warned you.

Important distinction 7: **wake-up call literal vs figurative**

Literal:

hotel phone call that wakes you.

Figurative:

event that makes you realize something important.

This is a classic lexicalized metaphor.

Important distinction 8: **wake vs awaken**

wake

more everyday, especially sleep.

awaken

more formal/literary and especially common figuratively.

> wake the baby

> 叫醒嬰兒

> awaken interest

> 喚起興趣

Important distinction 9: **awake vs alert**

awake

not sleeping.

alert

mentally attentive and ready to react.

You can be awake but not very alert.

Important distinction 10: **in the wake of vs after**

after

simple time sequence.

in the wake of

often emphasizes consequences following a major event.

- > after the crisis

- > 危機之後

- > in the wake of the crisis

- > 危機發生後，並帶着其後續影響

Important distinction 11: **wake as ship trail**

This noun is unrelated to sleep in modern usage.

- > ship's wake = 船的尾流

It is the source of figurative expressions like:

- > in the wake of

- > leave destruction in its wake

Important distinction 12: **wake as funeral gathering**

This is also unrelated to waking from sleep in everyday learner meaning.

Context is everything:

- > attend a wake

- > 參加守靈

not:

- > 去叫醒某人

Family-extension note

****Wake**** has several genuinely distinct modern branches:

1. ****sleep → consciousness****

* wake up

- * wake someone
- * awake
- * wide awake

2. **awareness**

- * wake up to something
- * wake-up call
- * awakening

3. **evoke**

- * wake memories
- * awaken interest

4. **ship trail**

- * a ship's wake
- * in the wake of
- * leave X in one's wake

5. **funeral custom**

- * a wake

For your passage, the exact branch is:

wake up = stop sleeping and begin the day earlier

And importantly, the passage also contains another member of the same family:

> **wake-up call**

meaning:

an event that suddenly makes you realize you need to change

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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wake up	醒來；起床	stop sleeping	
wake early	早醒	sleep	
wake someone up	叫醒某人	cause awakening	

awake	醒着的	not asleep	
wide awake	完全清醒	fully conscious	
stay awake	保持清醒	avoid sleep	
waking hours	清醒時段	non-sleep time	
wake up to X	開始意識到 X	realization	
wake someone up to X	使某人醒覺到 X	awareness	
wake-up call	當頭棒喝；警號	trigger realization	
wake-up call (hotel)	叫醒電話	literal service	
awakening	覺醒；醒悟	realization	
awaken interest	喚起興趣	activate feeling	
wake a memory	喚起記憶	evoke	
wake (water)	船尾流；航跡	trail in water	
in the wake of	在……之後 / 隨之而來	aftermath	
leave X in one's wake	在身後留下 X	consequence	
wake (funeral)	守靈；追悼聚會	funeral custom	

For your original sentence

> I also began **waking up earlier** and doing the hardest tasks first, while my mind was still fresh.

Here:

waking up earlier = 比以前更早結束睡眠、開始一天的活動

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我也開始**早起**，並先處理最困難的事情，因為那時候我的頭腦還最清醒。

And this passage gives us a nice family contrast:

> **wake up earlier** = 身體從睡眠中醒來

> **a wake-up call** = 心理上突然「醒覺」，意識到自己必須改變

That physical → figurative extension is the key polysemy link in the **wake** family.